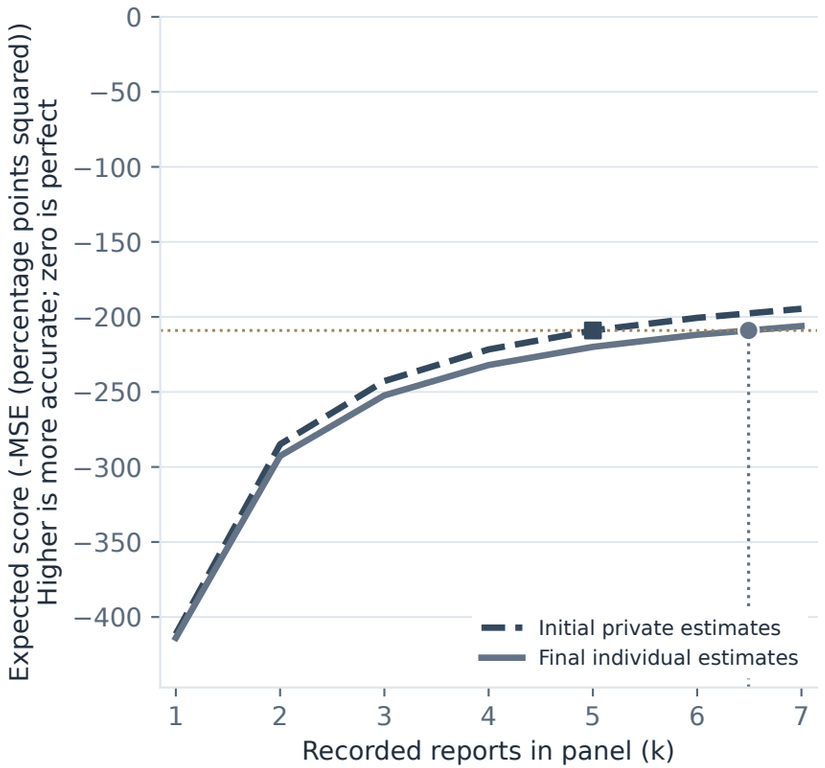
Private estimates, then a 90-second discussion

Seven percentage questions: private revision versus chat, with individual or group incentives.
All dashed lines show private estimates BEFORE discussion; solid lines show the subsequent individual answers.

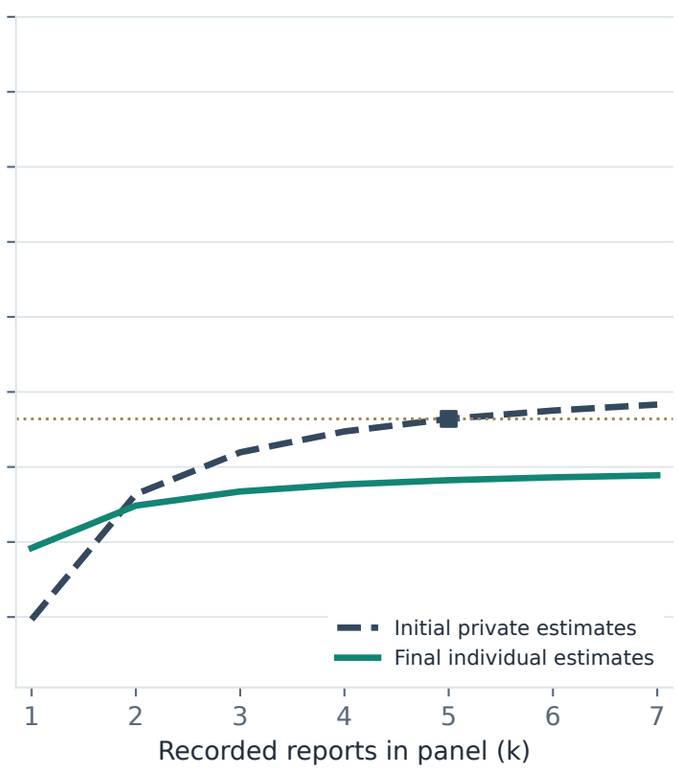
Later: private revision



6.49 final reports match 5 initial

Whole reports: 7 | 95% interval: 5 to >7
92 independent people; 644 paired person-question rows

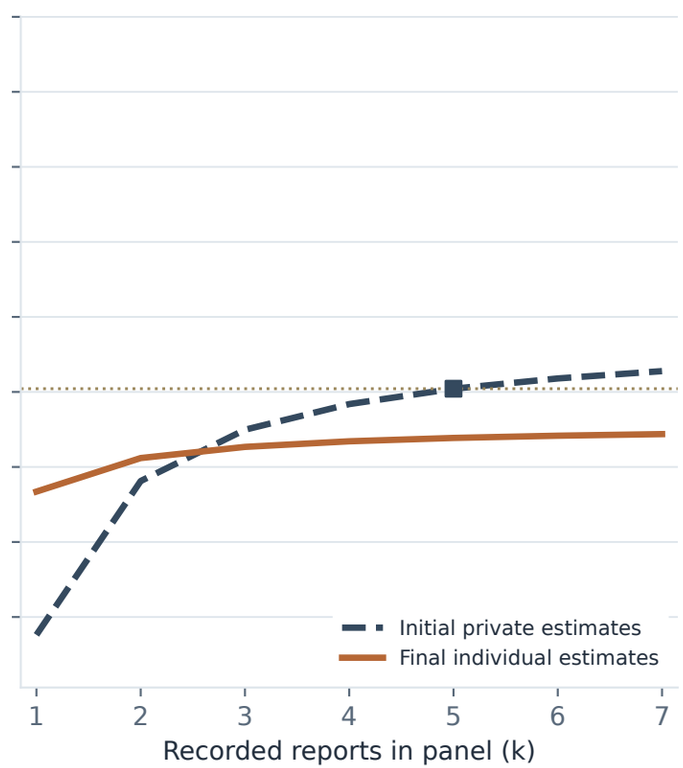
Later: chat / individual pay



No match within 7 final reports

Whole reports: >7 | 95% interval: 2 to >7
10 groups; 608 paired person-question rows

Later: chat / group pay



No match within 7 final reports

Whole reports: >7 | 95% interval: 3 to >7
10 groups; 613 paired person-question rows

Reference = 5 initial reports in the same condition. Some original groups have only 7 paired responses, so k stops at 7.
Control uncertainty resamples 92 independent people; chat uncertainty resamples 10 intact groups per incentive condition.

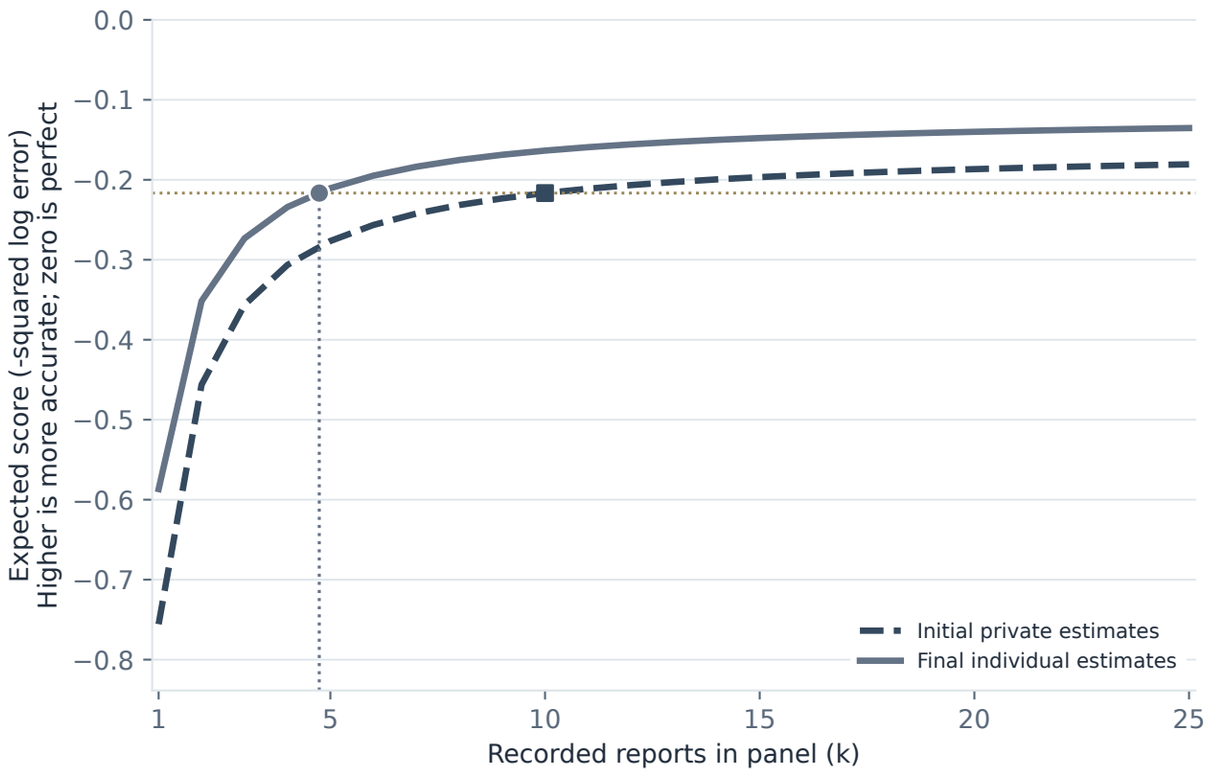
Every facet uses its own initial reference. Dashed = before feedback; solid = after revision.
k counts reports sampled from existing groups. It is not the number of participants needed to run the social experiment.

Gurcay, Mellers & Baron (2015) | doi.org/10.1002/bdm.1843 | Data: Almaatouq et al. repository

Partisan networks: experiment 1

Four factual questions about unemployment, taxes, California and the electorate.
Each social group contained one political party; participants were not told their peers shared that affiliation.

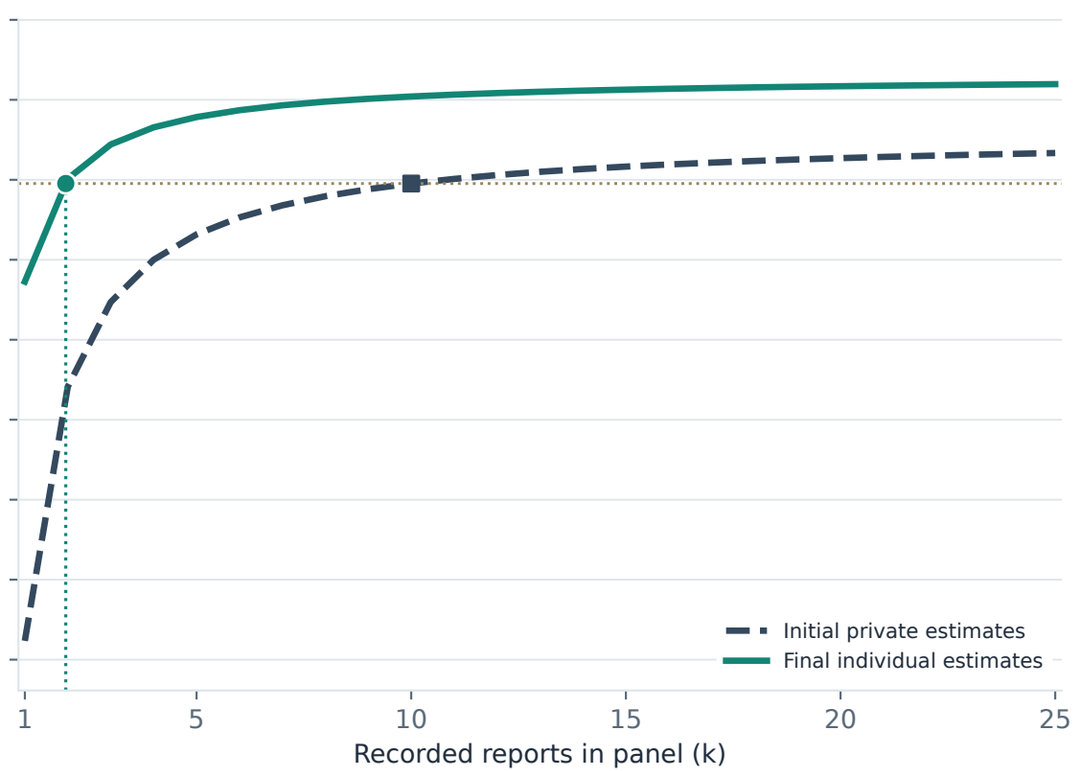
Later: private revision



4.74 final reports match 10 initial

Whole reports: 5 | 95% interval: 4 to 9
8 groups; 1,001 paired person-question rows

Later: feedback from four peers



1.95 final reports match 10 initial

Whole reports: 2 | 95% interval: 2 to 3
24 groups; 3,018 paired person-question rows

Panel estimate = geometric mean. Equal weight across groups; no mixed-party panels are constructed.
Bootstrap resamples intact groups within party, retaining both rounds and all questions.

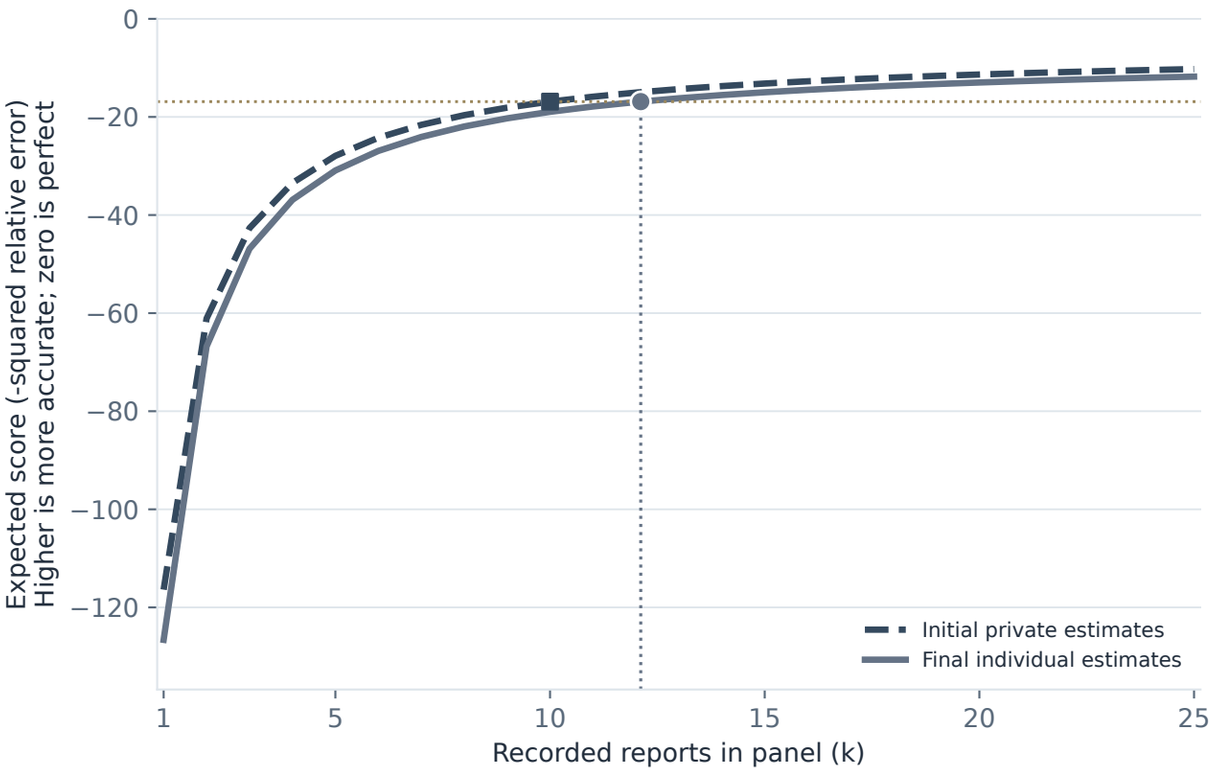
Every facet uses its own initial reference. Dashed = before feedback; solid = after revision.
k counts reports sampled from existing groups. It is not the number of participants needed to run the social experiment.

Becker, Porter & Centola (2019) | doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1817195116 | Original author release

Partisan networks: experiment 2

Four new questions, including signed changes in unemployment and immigration.
Here, shared party affiliation was disclosed and partisan symbols were shown; final answers follow two revisions.

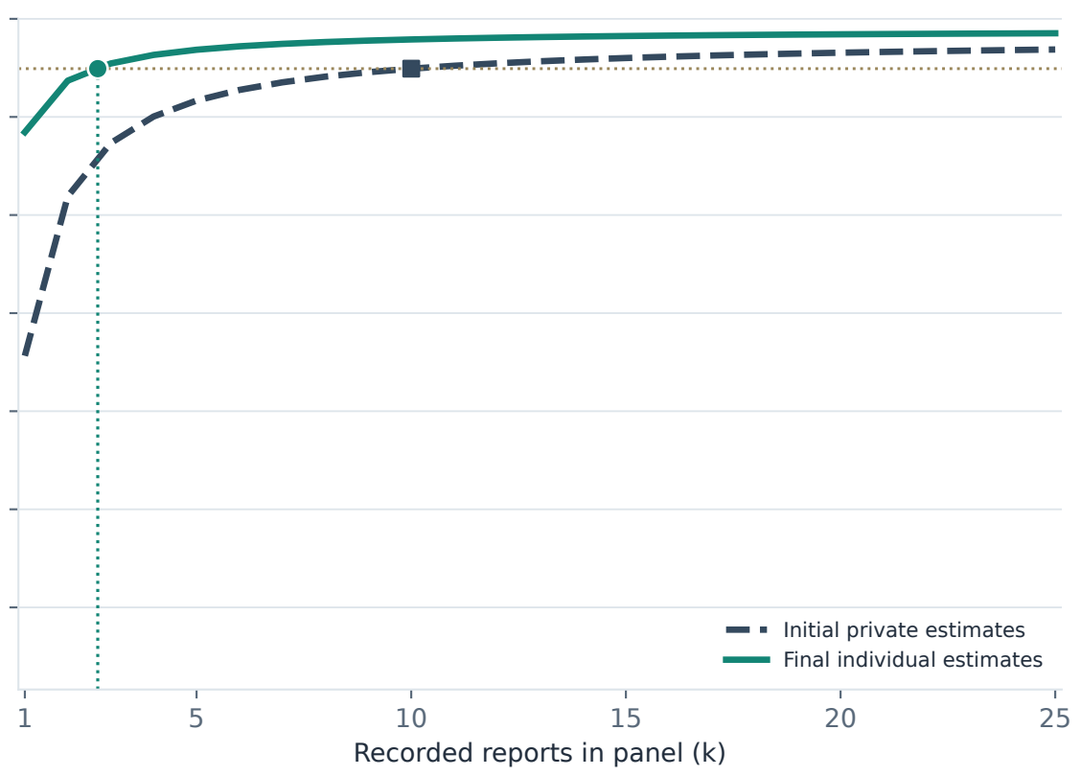
Later: private revision



12.11 final reports match 10 initial

Whole reports: 13 | 95% interval: 10 to 16
8 groups; 1,034 paired person-question rows

Later: feedback from four peers



2.70 final reports match 10 initial

Whole reports: 3 | 95% interval: 1 to 6
24 groups; 3,080 paired person-question rows

Panel estimate = arithmetic mean; errors divided by each question's true value, retaining its sign and decimals.
Author-flagged extreme rows are excluded; uncertainty resamples intact groups within party.

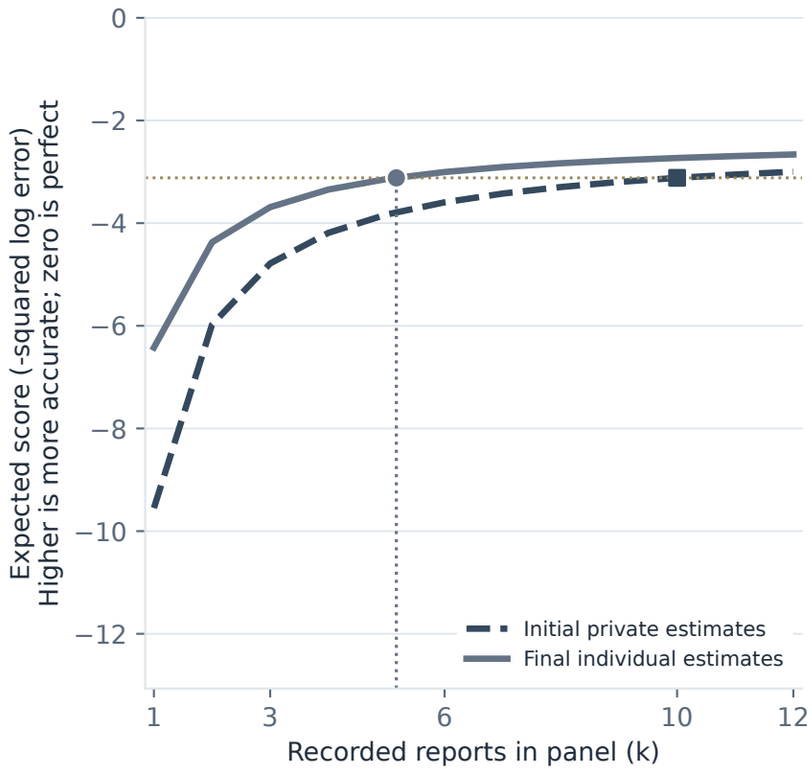
Every facet uses its own initial reference. Dashed = before feedback; solid = after revision.
k counts reports sampled from existing groups. It is not the number of participants needed to run the social experiment.

Becker, Porter & Centola (2019) | doi.org/10.1073/pnas.1817195116 | Original author release

How should other people's guesses be displayed?

216 people answered 42 questions in 18 groups of 12. All panels average over the same 42 questions.
Dashed lines: initial private estimates. Solid lines: revised estimates after the named information display.

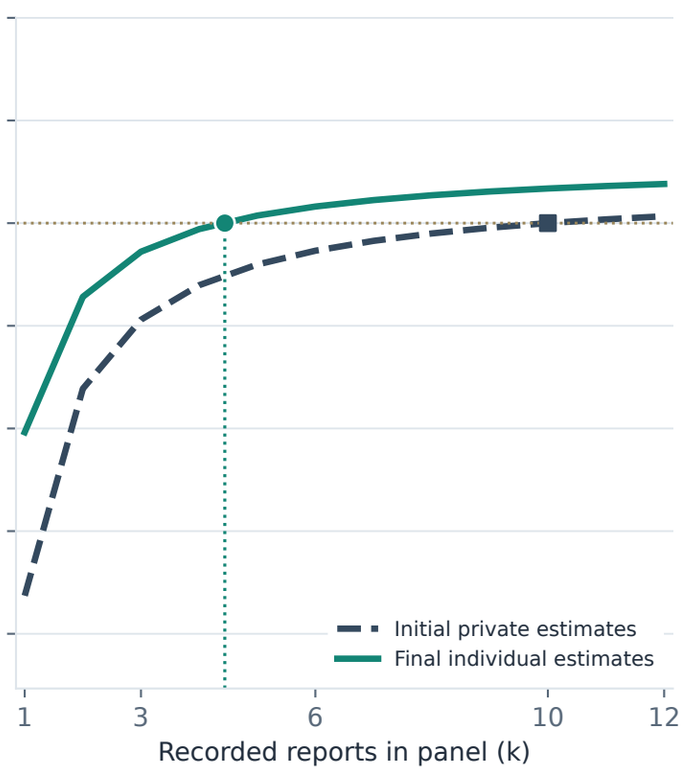
Later: sorted peer guesses



5.17 final reports match 10 initial

Whole reports: 6 | 95% interval: 4 to 8
6 groups; 3,024 paired person-question rows

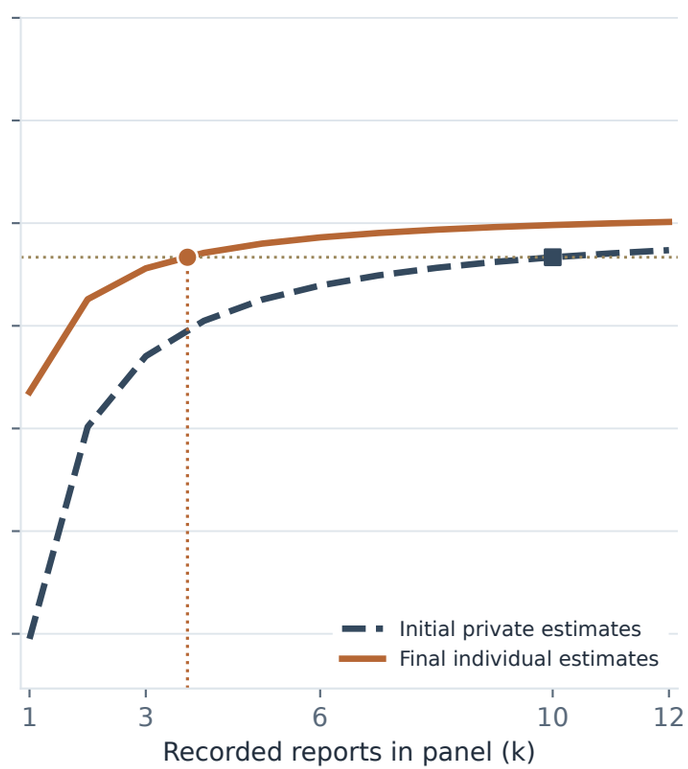
Later: unsorted peer guesses



4.44 final reports match 10 initial

Whole reports: 5 | 95% interval: 4 to 7
6 groups; 3,024 paired person-question rows

Later: peers' geometric mean



3.72 final reports match 10 initial

Whole reports: 4 | 95% interval: 3 to 5
6 groups; 3,024 paired person-question rows

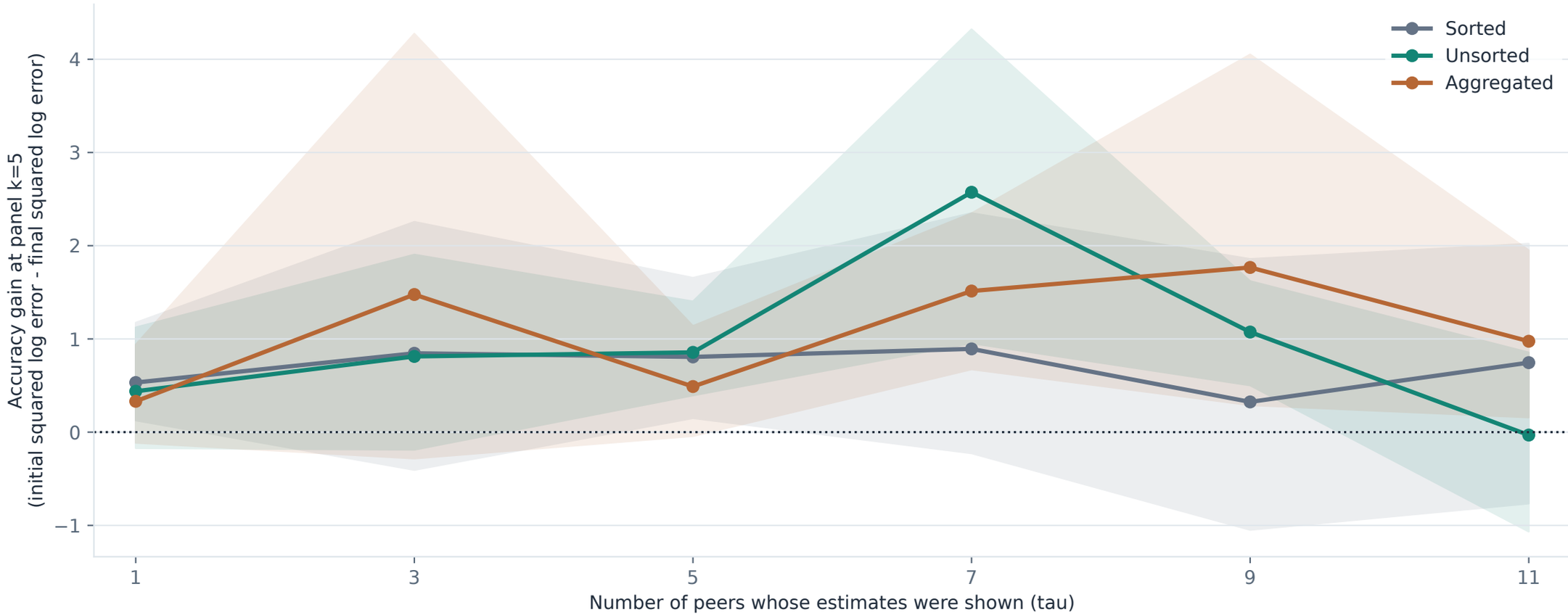
Panel estimate = geometric mean. Each display has 6 independent groups; intervals resample whole groups.
Curves average over 1, 3, 5, 7, 9 or 11 shared peer estimates. The next page separates that experimental factor.

Every facet uses its own initial reference. Dashed = before feedback; solid = after revision.
k counts reports sampled from existing groups. It is not the number of participants needed to run the social experiment.

Jayles, Sire & Kurvers (2021) | doi.org/10.1098/rsif.2021.0231 | Data: figshare 12529571

Does seeing more peers change the benefit?

Jayles experiment: participants actually saw 1, 3, 5, 7, 9 or 11 peers' estimates, or their geometric mean.
All results below use five recorded reports per panel. Positive values mean lower error after social information.



This horizontal axis is an experimental manipulation, not a resampled panel size.

Lines join observed condition means; no response model is fitted. Shading: exploratory pointwise 95% whole-group bootstrap intervals.
Each display has only 6 groups. Questions vary within group across tau; the 42-question coverage is balanced across groups.

These are paired before/after gains, not a formal causal comparison of display types or peer-count levels.

Jayles, Sire & Kurvers (2021) | doi.org/10.1098/rsif.2021.0231 | Data: figshare 12529571